



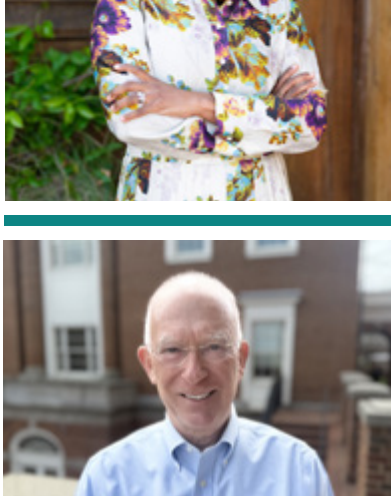
#AERA2026 Insider | April 10

Welcome to day three of the [2026 AERA Annual Meeting](#)! #AERA2026 *Insider* will provide tips on key sessions and events, as well as other Annual Meeting resources and highlights you won't want to miss.

Join the conversation: Follow #AERA2026 and AERA on [Bluesky](#), [LinkedIn](#), [Instagram](#), [Threads](#), [Facebook](#), and [X](#).

Questions? Contact the AERA Meetings team at annualmtg@aera.net.

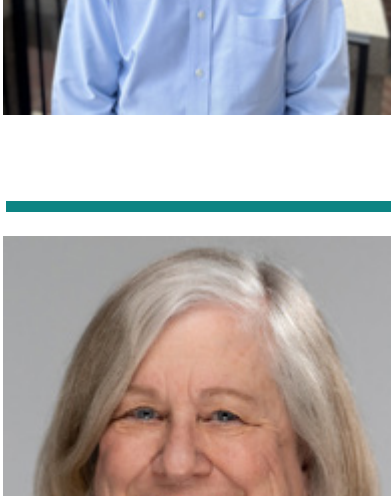
Today's Highlights



AERA Presidential Address—Maisha T. Winn

5:45 – 7:15 pm
Los Angeles Convention Center, Level One - Concourse Hall

In her Presidential Address, “The Future Is Here: Historical Signals in Education Research,” Maisha T. Winn builds the case that innovations in education should engage both historical methods and foresight thinking.



2025 Distinguished Contributions to Research in Education Award Lecture—Robert C. Pianta

3:45 – 5:15 pm
Los Angeles Convention Center, Level Two - Room 408B

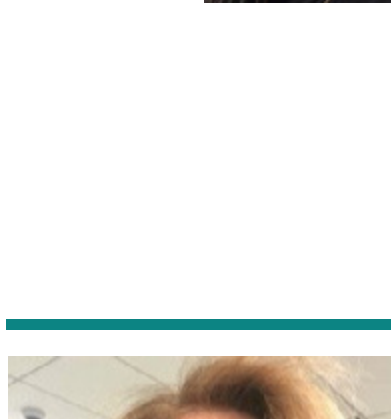
Robert C. Pianta will deliver the 2025 Distinguished Contributions to Research in Education Award Lecture, “Actionable and Relevant Education Science: Focus on People, Processes, and Contexts That Foster Students’ Learning and Development.” The lecture will argue that education research be oriented around a view of learning that is both comprehensive and personalized, and the relational, personal, and educational processes that support it.



2025 Distinguished Public Service Award Lecture—Joan Ferrini-Mundy

11:45 am – 1:15 pm
Los Angeles Convention Center, Level Two - Room 408B

Joan Ferrini-Mundy will deliver the 2025 Distinguished Public Service Award Lecture, “Evolving Research for Impact: People, Purposes, and Periods in Time Reflections on Public Service for STEM and Beyond.” The lecture will explore how dimensions of research for the public good evolve.

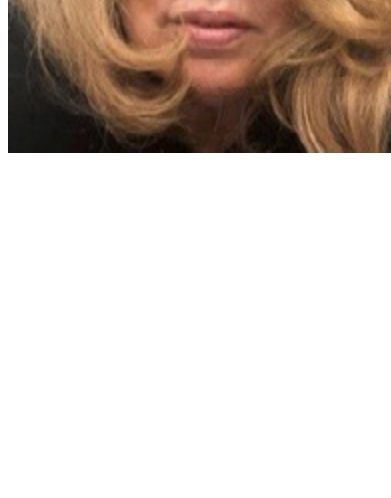


Futuring Against the Grain: Doctoral Students Charting New Paths in Education Research

9:45 – 11:15 am
Los Angeles Convention Center, Level One - Petree Hall C

Chairs: Cleveland Hayes (Indiana University - Indianapolis), Honey Walrond (University of California - Berkeley); Participants: Maria Cioe-Pena (University of Pennsylvania), Claudia G. Cervantes-Soon (Arizona State University), Ja'Nya Banks (University of California - Berkeley), Amura Cameron (Old Dominion University), Luis Alberto Legaspi (University of San Diego), Darion A. Wallace (Stanford University), Lucy Zhang (Teachers College, Columbia University)

Bringing together a diverse group of emerging scholars, the session explores how graduate research—spanning ethnography, historical analysis, policy discourse, narrative inquiry, participatory design, and AI—serves as a powerful vehicle for “intentional collective planning and future making.”

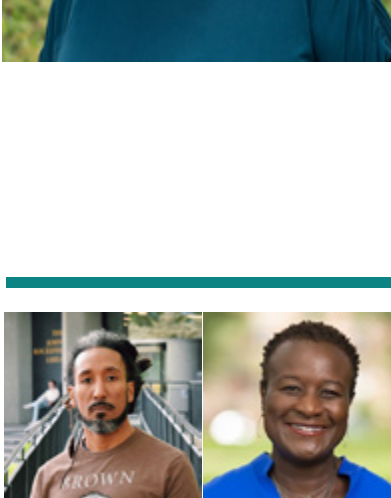


Historicizing Los Angeles: Envisioning New Educational Futures in Latinx Radical Imaginations

1:45 – 3:15 pm
Los Angeles Convention Center, Level Two - Room 403A

Chair: Kris D. Gutiérrez (University of California - Berkeley); Presenters: Laura K. Munoz (University of Nebraska - Lincoln), Alfredo J. Artiles (Stanford University), Gina Ann Garcia (University of California - Berkeley), Krista L. Cortes (University of Pennsylvania), Amalia Z. Dache (University of Pennsylvania), Cecilia Rios-Aguilar (University of California - Los Angeles), Anne-Marie Nunez (University of Texas - El Paso), Luis Urrieta (University of Texas at Austin), Omi Salas-SantaCruz (University of Utah), Dolores Delgado Bernal (Loyola Marymount University), William Perez (Loyola Marymount University), Cindy Cruz (University of Arizona)

Inspired by Los Angeles—the creative space where solidarities are built, futures are rehearsed, and radical educational imaginaries are part of its history—an interdisciplinary, intergenerational collective of Latinx scholars reimagine the possible, crafting a new analytical framework and transformative lens through which to develop historicized perceptions of the multiple worlds of Latinidad; a new framework that aspires to the “not-yet-here,” the proleptic imagination.

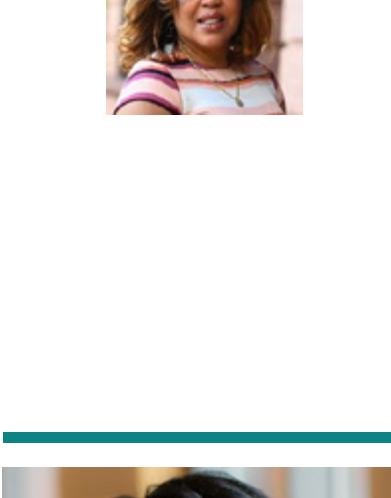


Indigenous Education Across Tovaangar: Past, Present, Trans-Indigenous, and Future Horizons

1:45 – 3:15 pm
Los Angeles Convention Center, Level Two - Room 406AB

Chair: Ananda M. Marin (University of California - Los Angeles); Panelists: Theresa J. Stewart-Ambo (University of California - Los Angeles), Kelly Leah Stewart (University of California, Los Angeles), Kēhaulani Vaughn (University of California - Riverside), Charles Sepulveda (University of Utah)

This presidential session brings together Tongva, Acjachemen, and Kanaka Maoli scholars and leaders to discuss Southern California–based efforts and movements in relation to Indigenous education and sovereignty across past, present, Trans-Indigenous, and future horizons.

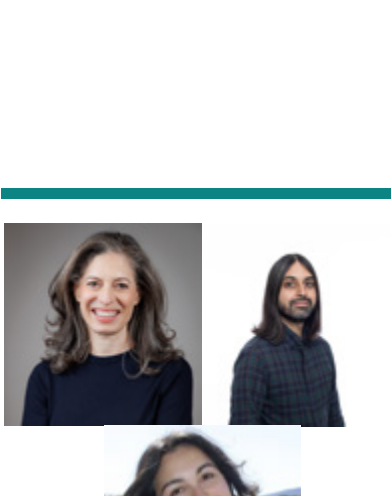


Emancipatory Artificial Intelligence: Unforgetting AI Histories to Reimagine Liberatory Futures

1:45 – 3:15 pm
Los Angeles Convention Center, Level Two - Room 403B

Chairs: Malik Boykin (Brown University); Discussants: Prudence L. Carter (Brown University), Ebony O. McGee (Johns Hopkins University); Presenters: Thema Monroe-White (George Mason University), Odis Johnson (Johns Hopkins University), Ezekiel J. Dixon-Roman (Teachers College, Columbia University), Thema Monroe-White (George Mason University)

This honorary presidential session convenes scholars at the intersection of educational equity and algorithmic justice to advance the 2026 AERA theme, “Unforgetting Histories and Imagining Futures.” Extending Thema Monroe-White’s Emancipatory Data Science framework, the session situates algorithmic harms within centuries of racial classification, surveillance, and communicentric bias.

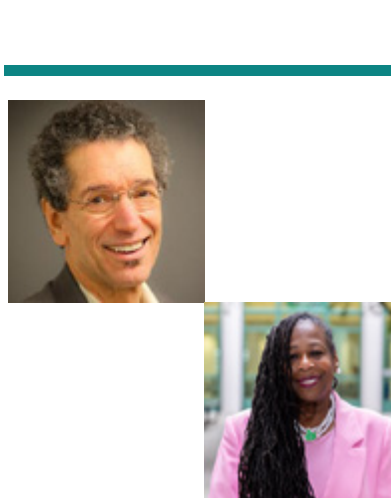


Looking Forward: Research Recommendations for Early Childhood Curriculum

9:45 – 11:15 am
Los Angeles Convention Center, Level Two - Room 408B

Chair: Vivian L. Gadsden (University of Pennsylvania); Participants: Andres Sebastian Bustamante (University of California - Irvine), Caroline Ebanks (Teachers College, Columbia University), Wintre Foxworth Johnson (University of Virginia), Christine M. McWayne (Tufts University)

Drawing on the recent research report Looking Forward: Research Recommendations for Early Childhood Curriculum, this interactive session will highlight major issues and recommendations for a future-oriented agenda to advance early childhood curriculum and implementation.

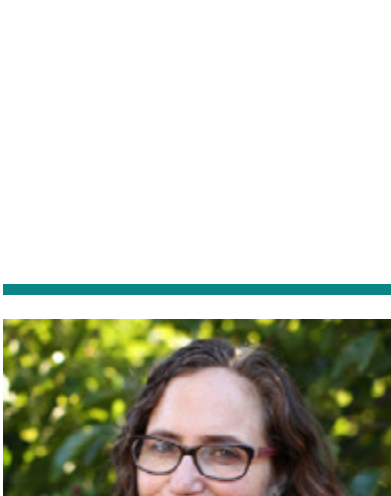


From Evidence to Headlines: Engaging Journalists in Challenging Times

11:45 am – 1:15 pm
Los Angeles Convention Center, Level Two - Room 501B

Moderator: Tony Pals (American Educational Research Association); Panelists: Jill Barshay (*The Hechinger Report*), Jaweed Kaleem (*Los Angeles Times*), Sequoia Carrillo (*National Public Radio*)

Join veteran education journalists for a candid discussion about how scholars can elevate timely research, engage effectively with reporters, and contribute meaningfully to coverage of K–12 and higher education. Panelists will share what makes research stand out, how to communicate complex findings clearly, and how to navigate media engagement during challenging times for education and academe.



Unforgetting Histories, Defending Futures: An Interactive Town Hall on Censorship and Democratic Schooling

1:45 – 3:15 pm
Los Angeles Convention Center, Level Two - Room 511AB

Chairs: David M. Osher (Education Collaboratory at Yale University), Brenda L. Townsend Walker (University of South Florida); Participants: Brenda L. Townsend Walker (University of South Florida), David M. Osher (Education Collaboratory at Yale University), Sameer Sourav (UCLA Community Schools), Pedro A. Noguera (University of Southern California), Angela Lopez (UCLA Community Schools), Mark Rosenbaum (Public Counsel), Megan Bang (Northwestern University)

Conflicts over curriculum, censorship, and historical memory are intensifying across P–12 schools and universities, reshaping what can be taught, funded, researched, and publicly discussed. This interactive town hall examines how historical erasure and ideological suppression affect educators, students, and democratic life.



Reimagining the Institute of Education Sciences: Reflections and Perspectives from the Field

3:45 – 5:15 pm
Los Angeles Convention Center, Level Two - Room 406AB

Chair: Michal Kurlaender (University of California - Davis); Participants: Adam Gamoran (William T. Grant Foundation), Nicole Patton-Terry (Florida State University), Kristabel Stark (University of Vermont), Michelle Crosby (American Statistical Association)

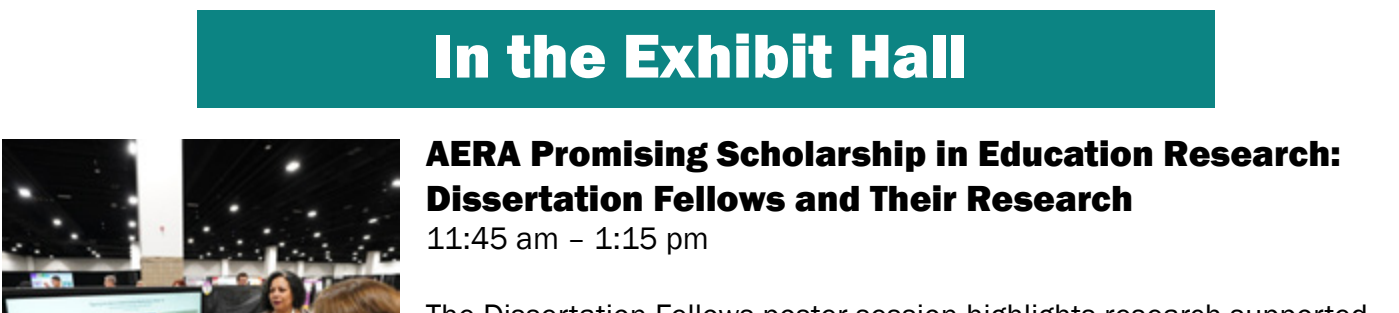
The February 2026 report, Reimagining the Institute of Education Sciences (IES): A Strategy for Relevance and Renewal, provides cross-cutting “big shifts” and recommendations for each of the IES centers as part of the Department of Education’s intent to reform IES. This invited panel will feature reflections on the potential implications of these recommendations for the statistics, research, special education research, and practice-oriented activities that IES funding helps support.



AERA Graduate Student Research-in-Progress Roundtables

1:45 – 3:15 pm
Los Angeles Convention Center, Level One – Petree Hall C

The Graduate Student Research-in-Progress Roundtable Series gives accepted graduate students the opportunity to share and discuss their work in progress onsite in Los Angeles. The roundtable series features graduate students who are actively engaged in research but were not yet ready to advance a paper submission in response to the 2026 Call for Submissions.



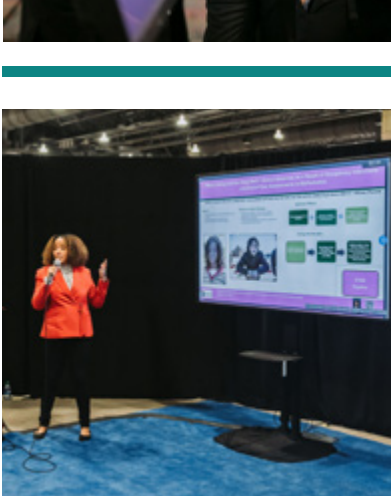
In the Exhibit Hall



AERA Promising Scholarship in Education Research: Dissertation Fellows and Their Research

11:45 am – 1:15 pm

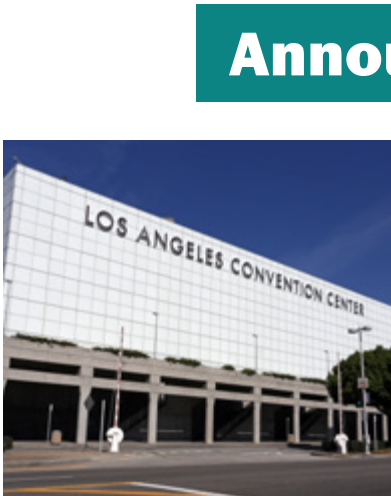
The Dissertation Fellows poster session highlights research supported by the AERA-NSF Grants Program, the AERA Minority Dissertation Fellowship Program in Education Research, and the NAEd/Spencer Dissertation Fellowship Program.



2026 AERA Undergraduate Fellows Research Poster Fair

3:45 – 5:15 pm

This poster session provides an opportunity for the undergraduate students who are participating in the Undergraduate Student Education Research Training Workshop to visually display their work and receive comments and guidance from the education research community.



e-Lighting Ed-Talks

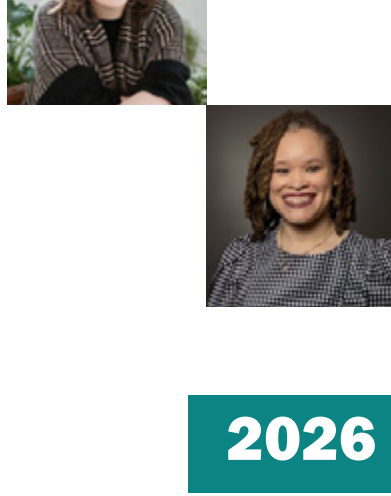
Nearly 400 e-Lighting Ed-Talks will feature selected poster authors presenting their work in the form of brief and engaging presentation. These 4-to-7-minute-long talks will be held throughout the day, on every day of the meeting, in the Exhibit Hall.

Announcements and Resources



On-Site Registration Location

Registration is in the LA Convention Center at 1201 S. Figueroa Street through the West Entrance (the entrance closest to the Crypto.com Arena).



Download the #AERA2026 Mobile App

With the 2026 AERA Annual Meeting Mobile App, you can build a personalized schedule, rate the sessions you attend, connect with colleagues and friends, and more! Download on the [Apple App Store](#) or [Google Play Store](#).



Meet the #AERA2026 Ombuds

The [ombuds](#) is a neutral, confidential, informal, and independent resource made available to hear persons’ concerns and assist them by identifying options and resources to address conflicts or issues.

The ombuds will be available during the 2026 Annual Meeting for in-person, video, or phone appointments. The ombuds offices are in the JW Marriott Los Angeles L.A. LIVE on the third floor in Olympic I. To schedule an appointment with the ombuds email your request to aeraombuds@gmail.com. You may also reach out by phone at (202) 505-3356.

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